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MAURITIUS EXAMINATIONS SYNDICATE

Primary School Achievement Certificate Assessment

For first Assessment in 2026

SPECIMEN PAPER

Time: 1 hour 45 Minutes

Total Marks: 100

SCIENCE

(Subject code No. P141/3)

1. Check that this assessment booklet contains **10** questions printed on **22** pages numbered 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22 and 23.
2. Write your Index Number on the assessment booklet in the space provided above.
3. You should not use red, green or black ink in answering questions.
4. Write all your answers clearly in the assessment booklet.
5. Attempt all questions.

Question	Marking			Revision			Control		
	Marks		Sig	Marks		Sig	Marks		Sig
1									
2									
3									
4									
5									
6									
7									
8									
9									
10									
Total									
Sig (HoG)									

Question 1 (10 marks)

Circle the correct answer. Each item carries one mark.

a) Which group of animals lives both on land and in water?

- A** Amphibians
- B** Birds
- C** Fish
- D** Insects

b) Which one of the following birds is **endemic** to **Rodrigues**?

- A** Cardinal Jaune
- B** Echo Parakeet
- C** Pic Pic
- D** Pink Pigeon

c) Which one of the following is a measure to protect our beaches?

- A** Building jetties on the beach
- B** Building camping sites on the beach
- C** Removing coral reefs from the lagoon
- D** Planting mangroves along the coast

d) Which of the following objects uses air pressure to function?

- A** A phone
- B** A fan
- C** A radio
- D** A syringe

e) Which of the following plants is **non-flowering**?



A Goyave de Chine



B Fern

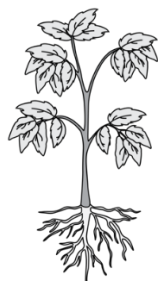


C Papaya tree



D Hibiscus

f) **Diagram 1** shows two plants, Plant **A** and Plant **B**. Part of Plant **B** is cut off. Plant **A** and Plant **B** are then planted in the soil.



Plant **A**



Plant **B**

Diagram 1: Plants **A** and **B**

After a few days, Plant **A** grows healthily. Plant **B** withers and dies.

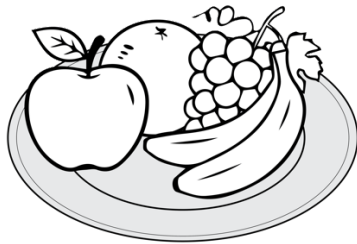
Which of the following explains why Plant **B** withered and died?

- A** It could not absorb water from the soil.
- B** It could not carry out germination.
- C** It could not attract insects.
- D** It could not produce fruits.

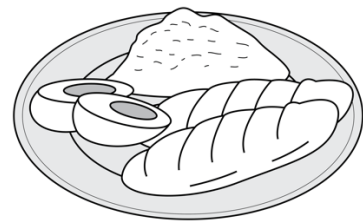
g) Which conditions are necessary for **rusting** to take place?

- A Sunlight and water
- B Air and suitable temperature
- C Water and air
- D Suitable temperature and sunlight

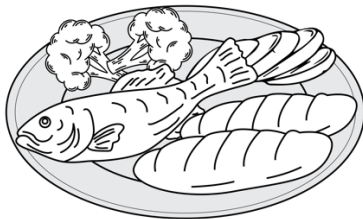
h) Which of the following is a **balanced** meal?



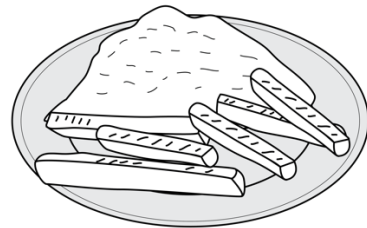
A Apple, banana and grapes



B Rice, bread and eggs

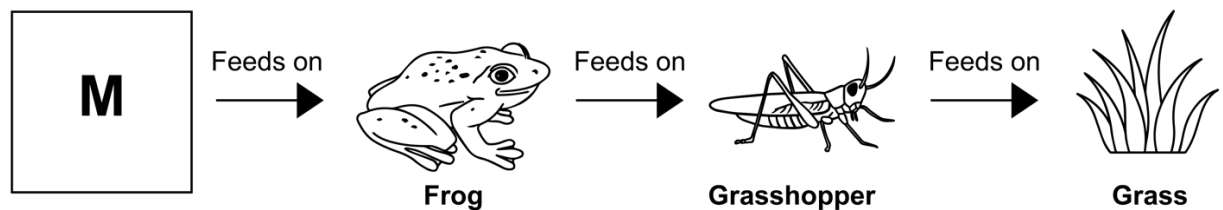


C Fish, vegetables and bread



D Rice and potato chips

i) Study the interaction below.



What does **M** represent?

- | | |
|-------|---------|
| A Air | B Cow |
| C Sun | D Snake |

j) **Diagram 2** shows oil burning in a cooking pot.

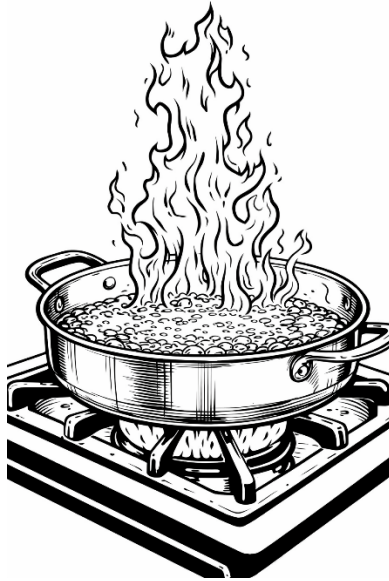


Diagram 2: Oil burning

How can the fire in the cooking pot be **extinguished**?

- A** By pouring water over the fire
- B** By covering the pot with a metal lid
- C** By increasing the gas supply
- D** By supplying oxygen to the fire

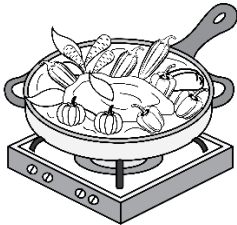
Question 2 (7 marks)

- a) For each of the following sources of energy, tick (✓) the box showing its correct characteristics.

Source of energy	Characteristics
 Coal	☐ Renewable and polluting ☐ Renewable and non-polluting ☐ Non-renewable and polluting
 Bagasse	☐ Renewable and polluting ☐ Renewable and non-polluting ☐ Non-renewable and polluting
 Water	☐ Renewable and polluting ☐ Renewable and non-polluting ☐ Non-renewable and polluting

[3]

- b) Complete the table below by giving the **main** transformation of energy that takes place in each of the following situations.

Situation	Energy transformation
 A child eating	 energy found in food is transformed into heat energy.
 Girl playing a guitar	Movement energy is transformed intoenergy.
 A movie on a television set	 energy is transformed into sound and light energy.
 Cooking food on a gas stove	Chemical energy from fossil fuels is transformed into energy to cook the food.

[4]

Question 3 (12 marks)

a) **Diagram 3** shows the water cycle.

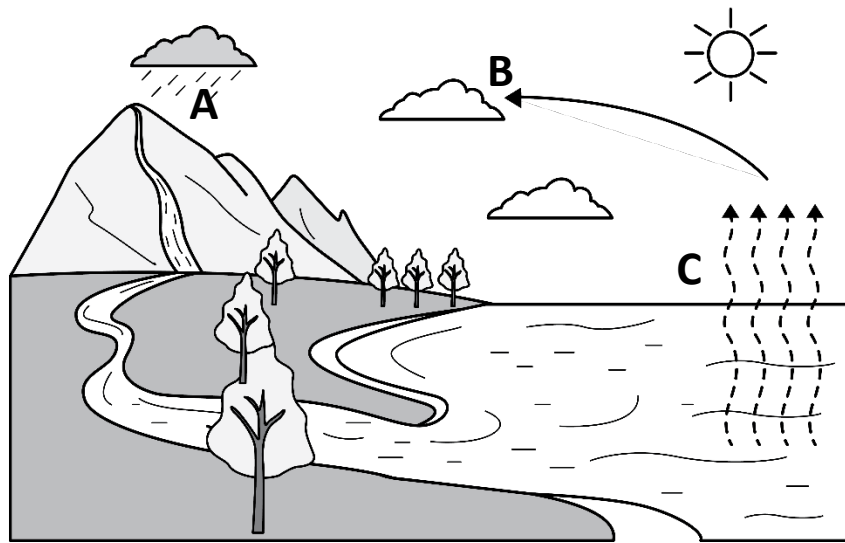


Diagram 3: The water cycle

- (i) Which of the letters, **A**, **B** or **C** in **Diagram 3** represents the evaporation process?

.....

[1]

- (ii) Name the two other processes in the water cycle.

1.

2.

[2]

b) Alia finds water droplets on the grass outside her house on a summer morning.

It did not rain at night nor in the morning.

Explain how the water droplets were formed.

.....

.....

[2]

c) Which of the following statements are correct? Tick (✓) the **three** correct boxes.

1. Ice is water in the gas form.

☐

2. There is snow on the top of Mount Everest because of the low temperature.

☐

3. Ice is used in drinks because it is slippery.

☐

4. A hydro power station uses water to produce electricity.

☐

5. Water freezes and ice melts at the same temperature.

☐

[3]

d) Yan puts some clear seawater in a dish. He leaves it under the sun for a week.

After a week, he finds only a white solid in the dish, as shown in **Diagram 4**.

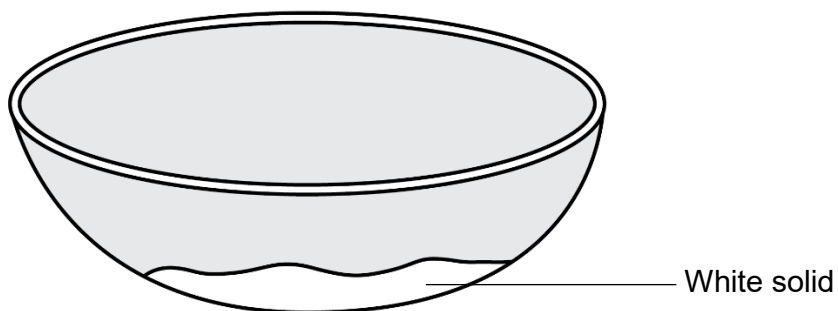


Diagram 4: White solid in the dish

What is the white solid formed?

.....

[1]

e) Lena wants to find out the temperature at which water and seawater boil.

(i) Which apparatus should Lena use to measure **temperature**?

.....

[1]

She carries out the following steps:

1. She measures the temperature of boiling water.
2. She measures the temperature of boiling seawater.
3. She repeats steps 1 and 2.

Table 1 shows her readings.

Table 1: Lena's readings

	Temperature	
	Reading 1	Reading 2
Water	100 °C	100°C
Seawater	102°C	102°C

(ii) What can Lena conclude about the temperatures at which water and seawater boil?

.....

.....

[1]

(iii) Why is it important that Lena repeats steps 1 and 2?

.....

[1]

Question 4 (10 marks)

- a) Answer the following questions by choosing the correct word(s) from the list below.

nitrogen, carbon dioxide, oxygen, water vapour

- (i) Which gas is present in the largest amount in the atmosphere?

.....

[1]

- (ii) Which gas is absent in dry air?

.....

[1]

- (iii) Which gas is taken in by plants in the absence of light?

.....

[1]

- b) What is the percentage of oxygen in air? Tick (✓) the correct box.

☐

0.03%

☐

21%

☐

78%

[1]

c) **Diagram 5** shows different sources of air pollution.



Diagram 5: Sources of air pollution

(i) What is air pollution?

.....

.....

[1]

(ii) Give one source of air pollution shown in **Diagram 5**.

.....

[1]

(iii) Give one measure that can be taken to prevent air pollution from the source shown in **Diagram 5**.

.....

.....

[1]

(iv) Why is it important for people to protect themselves against air pollution?

.....

.....

[1]

d) Give two ways in which air pollution prevents plants from manufacturing their food.

1.

2.

[2]

Question 5 (10 marks)

- a) Materials are chosen for specific purposes according to their properties.

A list of properties of different materials is given below.

is elastic

is transparent

is strong

conducts electricity

absorbs sweat

is rare

Complete the following sentences by choosing the correct property of the material used to make the object.

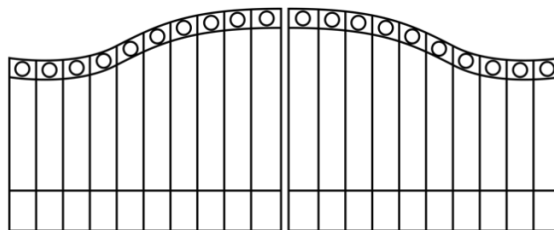
- (i) The window pane is made of glass.



This is because glass

[1]

- (ii) Iron is used to make gates.



This is because iron

[1]

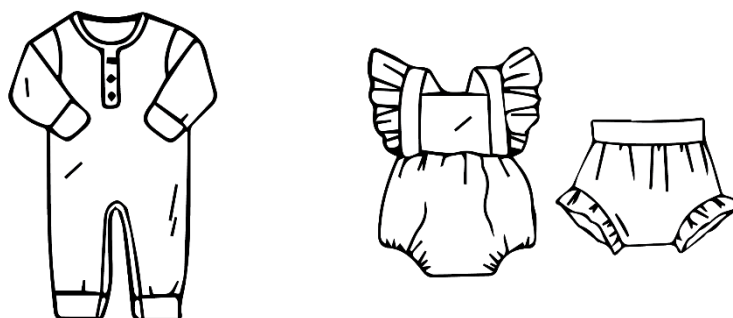
- (iii) Gold is used to make pieces of jewellery.



This is because gold

[1]

(iv) Baby clothes are made of cotton.



This is because cotton [1]

b) In the table below, classify the following materials either as natural or man-made.

Nylon, Iron, Steel, Wool

Natural	Man-made

[4]

c) Anya carries out an experiment on the water permeability of three different materials: paper, plastic and cotton cloth.

1. She places a paper cover on an empty glass as shown in **Diagram 6**.

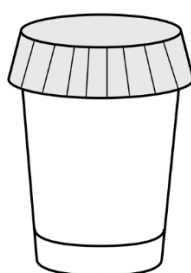


Diagram 6: Empty glass covered with a paper cover

2. She pours 10 ml of water on the paper cover.
3. She records the amount of water collected in the glass.
4. She repeats steps 1 to 3 twice, once with a plastic cover and once with a piece of cotton cloth. She uses the **same** amount of water each time.
5. She records the amount of water collected in the glass as shown in **Table 2**.

Table 2: Amount of water collected in the glass

Materials	Amount of water collected in the glass/ ml
Paper cover	5
Plastic cover	0
Cotton cloth cover	8

- (i) Arrange the materials in order of permeability, starting from the least permeable to the most permeable.

Least permeable

Most permeable

..... [1]

- (ii) Suggest a reason why **8 ml** of water was collected and not **10 ml** when the experiment was carried out with the cotton cloth.

..... [1]

Question 6 (12 marks)

- a) Animals are classified according to the types of food they eat.

Complete **Table 3**.

Table 3

Group of animals	Food eaten	Example of animal
Herbivore	Plants	
Carnivore		Lion
.....	Fruits and small animals	

[4]

- b) Give one difference between milk teeth and permanent teeth.

.....

[2]

- c) In the 1970s, only 15 Mauritius Kestrels remained in our forests. This number increased to 200 in 2020.

Suggest two measures that were taken to increase the number of Mauritius Kestrels over the years.

1.

2.

[2]

- d) What could have happened to the Mauritius Kestrels if no measure had been taken?

.....

[1]

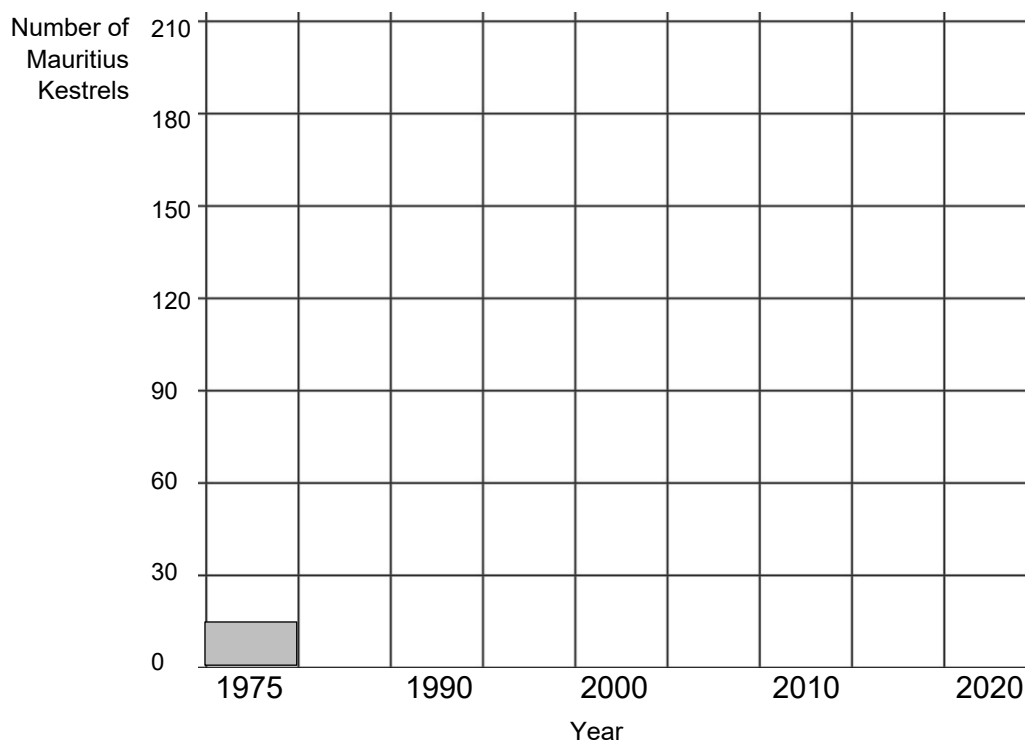
- e) **Table 4** shows the number of Mauritius Kestrels in Mauritius from 1975 to 2020.

Table 4: Number of Mauritius Kestrels

Year	Number of Mauritius Kestrels
1975	15
1990	60
2000	120
2010	150
2020	210

- (i) In the space below, draw a bar chart to show the number of Mauritius Kestrels from 1975 to 2020.

The first bar has been drawn for you.



[2]

- (ii) What is the increase in the population of the Mauritius Kestrels from 1990 to 2000?

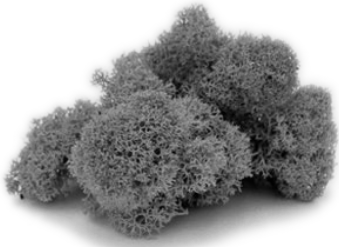
.....

[1]

Question 7 (11 marks)

- a) The table below shows different plants. Choose the most appropriate habitat for each plant and explain how the plant is adapted to its habitat.

The first one has been done for you.

Plants	Natural habitat	How the plant is adapted to its natural habitat
Example:  Mangrove	A In deserts B In wetlands C On mountains	Its roots are found above the ground to get enough oxygen.
 Cactus	A In marshy lands B In deserts C On mountains	
 Hyacinth	A In fresh water B In dry soil C In the sand	
 Moss	A On sandy beaches B In deserts C On trunks of big trees	

[6]

- b) Name the process by which plants manufacture their food.

.....

[1]

- c) Kevin carries out the experiment below to test a condition necessary for plants to manufacture their food.

1. He uses two identical potted plants, **Plant A** and **Plant B**.
2. He places **Plant A** inside a dark box.
3. He places **Plant B** in sunlight.

Diagram 7 shows **Plant A** and **Plant B**.

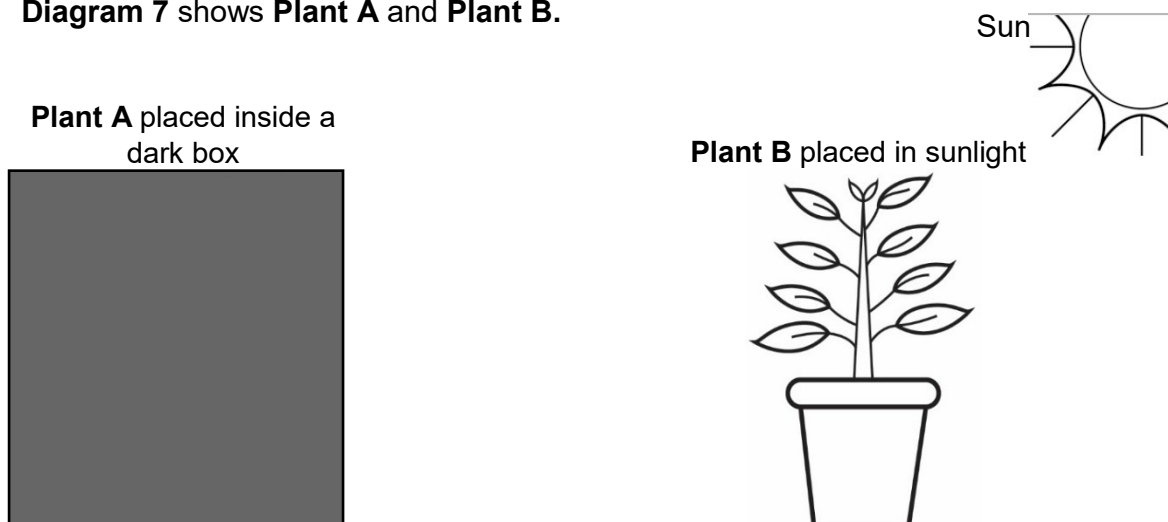


Diagram 7: Plant A in a dark box and **Plant B** in sunlight

- (i) Which condition is Kevin testing in this experiment?

.....

[1]

- (ii) Why does Kevin need two plants in his experiment?

.....

.....

[1]

- d) State two other conditions necessary for plants to manufacture their food.

1.

2.

[2]

Question 8 (9 marks)

- a) Give one way in which the Earth and the Sun are different.

..... [1]

- b) The movements of the Earth help us measure time.

- (i) Complete **Table 4**.

Table 4

Earth's movement	Time taken
Earth rotates on its axis once.	 hours
.....	365 $\frac{1}{4}$ days

[2]

- (ii) Based on the table above, why do we have a "leap year" every four years?

.....

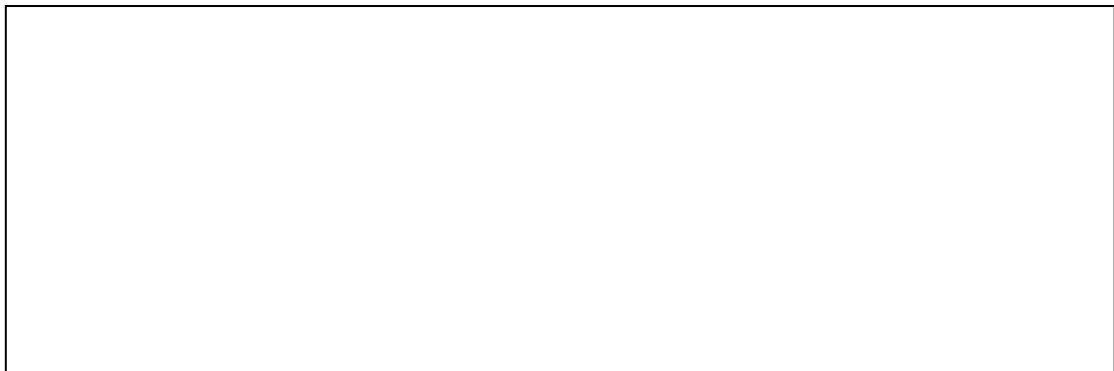
..... [1]

- c) (i) In the space provided below, draw a simple diagram to show the sizes and the positions of the Earth, the Moon and the Sun in the solar system.

[2]

- (ii) On your diagram, shade the side of the Earth that is experiencing night.

[1]



- d) Give two reasons why life exists on Earth.

1.

2.

[2]

Question 9 (9 marks)

a) Which of the following defines an ecosystem?

- A** The different types of animals living in an area
- B** The living and non-living things interacting in an area
- C** The number of animals living in an area

[1]

b) What is global warming?

.....
.....

[1]

c) Name two human activities that contribute to global warming.

- 1.
- 2.

[2]

d) Global warming causes the ice at the North and South Poles to melt.

Give two ways how the melting of ice at the poles can affect coastal fishing villages.

- 1.
- 2.

[2]

e) Explain how using solar water heaters helps to reduce global warming.

.....
.....

[1]

f) Give another way in which you could help reduce global warming when

(i) traveling to school.

.....

(ii) at school.

.....

[2]

Question 10 (10 marks)

- a) **Diagram 8** shows a game. To win the game, a player should move a metal loop along a metal track without touching it.

The game makes up a **simple electric circuit**.

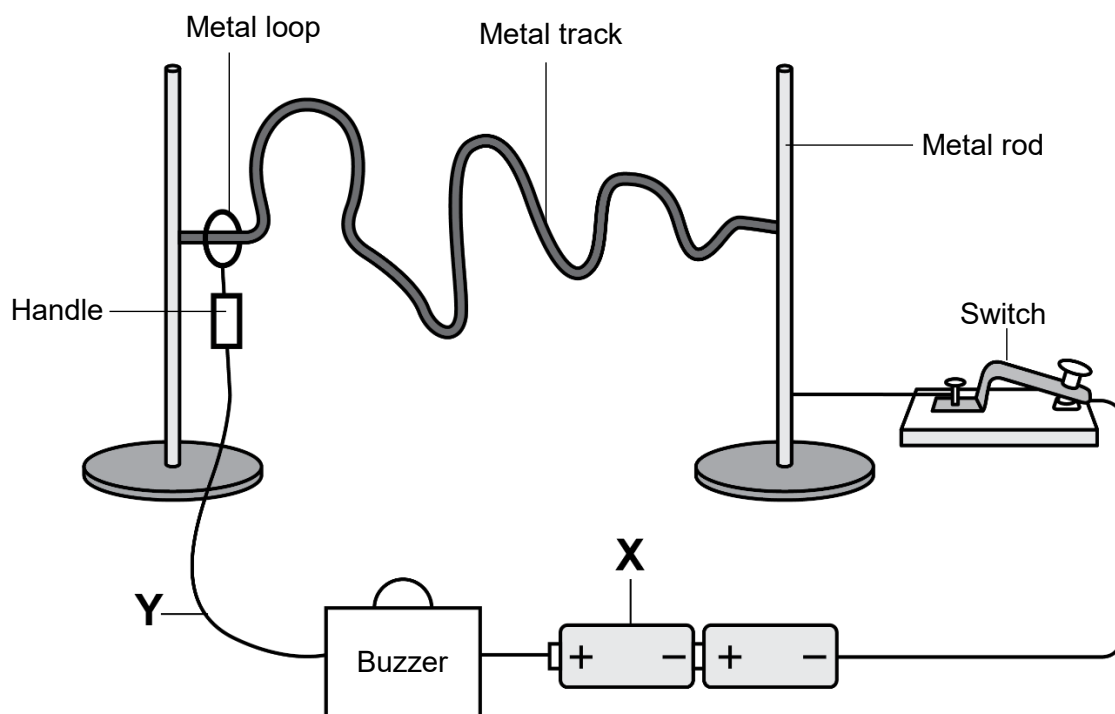


Diagram 8: A game

- (i) Name components **X** and **Y** in **Diagram 8**.

X:

Y:

[2]

- (ii) When the metal loop touches the metal track, the buzzer rings.

Explain why the buzzer rings when the metal loop touches the metal track.

.....

[1]

- b) Sara sets up the same game for her science class. She uses the same materials as in **Diagram 8**. She builds the circuit shown in **Diagram 9**.

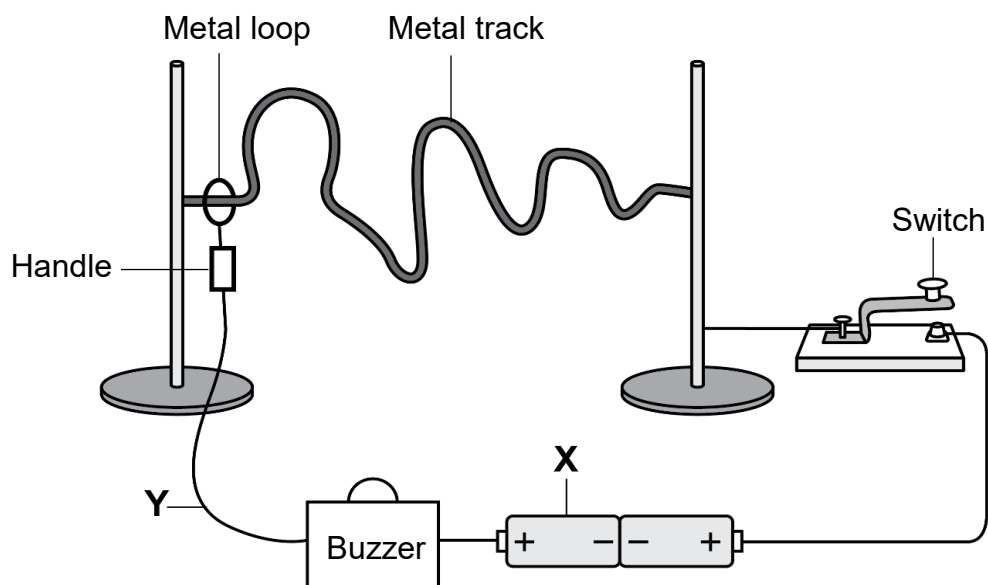


Diagram 9: Sara's game

When the metal loop touches the metal track in Sara's game, the buzzer **does not** ring.

- (i) Suggest two ways in which Sara can make the buzzer ring.

1.

2.

[2]

- (ii) Suggest one way in which Sara can make the buzzer ring more loudly after fixing it.

.....

[1]

- c) The handle Sara uses to move the loop is covered with plastic. Give a reason why the handle should be covered with plastic.

.....

[1]

- d) State the energy transformation that takes place in the circuit when the buzzer rings.

In component X	In component Y	In the Buzzer
..... energy	 energy	 energy

[3]

End of Paper

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